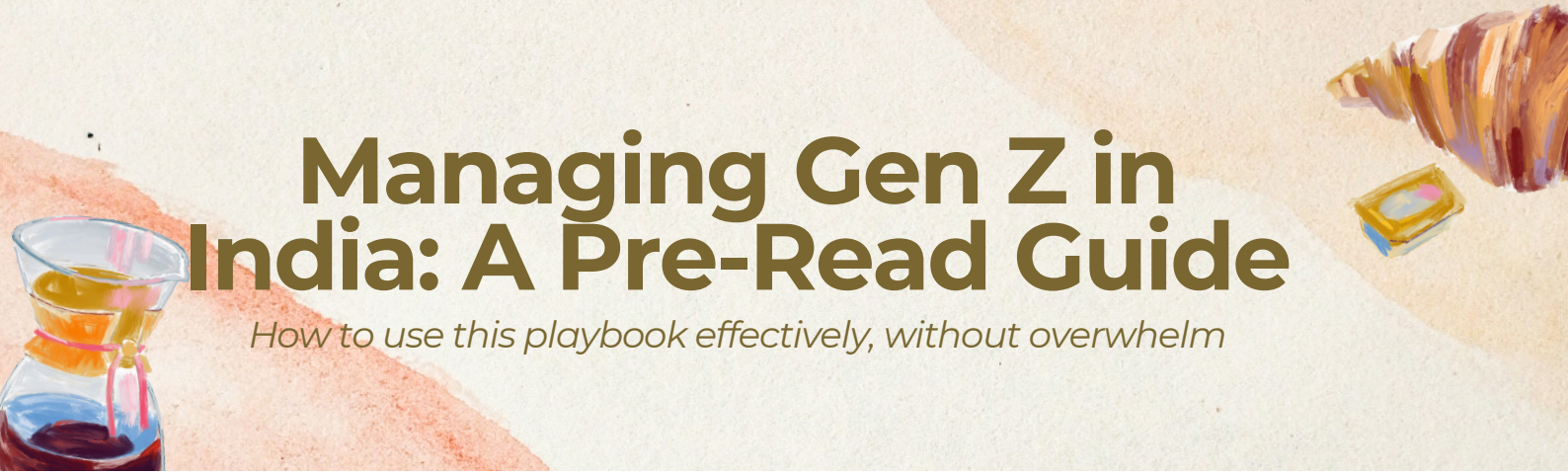


Managing Gen Z in India: A Pre-Read Guide

How to use this playbook effectively, without overwhelm

Why this Playbook will actually help you?

If you are reading this, you are likely experiencing one or more of the following:

- Feedback feels risky
- Pushback feels personal
- Growth conversations feel tense
- Mental health discussions feel uncomfortable
- Discipline feels like a minefield

This playbook exists because **traditional management advice no longer fits today's workplace realities in India.**

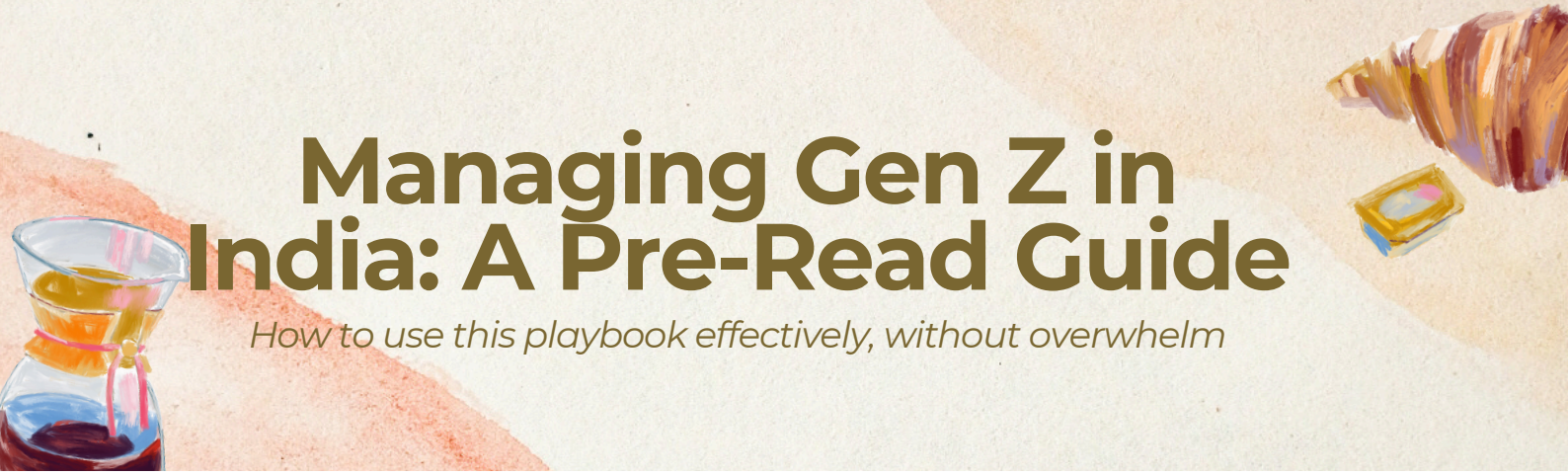
You are not expected to:

- change your personality
- become overly soft
- avoid difficult conversations

You are expected to:

- maintain performance
- reduce friction
- communicate with clarity
- lead across generations

This playbook focuses on **how conversations are handled,** not on changing who you are as a leader.



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Using the Playbook based on Diagnostic

If you have completed the **Gen Z–Manager Relationship Health Diagnostic**, use this playbook **selectively**, not sequentially.

Start where the friction is highest.

If your top friction zone is:

Feedback & Performance
→ Start with **Module 2: Feedback Without Trauma**

Resistance & Pushback
→ Start with **Module 3: Handling Resistance & Entitlement**

Growth & Promotion Expectations
→ Start with **Module 4: Growth & Promotion Conversations**

Burnout & Work Boundaries
→ Start with **Module 5: Burnout & Mental Health**

Discipline & Accountability
→ Start with **Module 6: Discipline Without Toxicity**

You do not need to fix everything at once.
Solve the **most urgent issue first**.

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Quick start based on your role

Different roles experience different leadership challenges.
Use the guide below to prioritise your reading.

If You Are a First-Time Manager

Your biggest challenges are likely:

- hesitation with feedback
- emotional reactions under pressure
- unclear expectations

Start with:

- Module 2 (Feedback Without Trauma)
- Module 3 (Resistance & Entitlement)

Important: Use the scripts exactly as written initially.

If You Are a Mid-Level or Senior Manager

Your biggest challenges are likely:

- misreading pushback
- unclear growth communication
- delayed discipline

Start with:

- Module 3 (Resistance & Entitlement)
- Module 4 (Growth & Promotion Conversations)

- Module 6 (Discipline Without Toxicity)

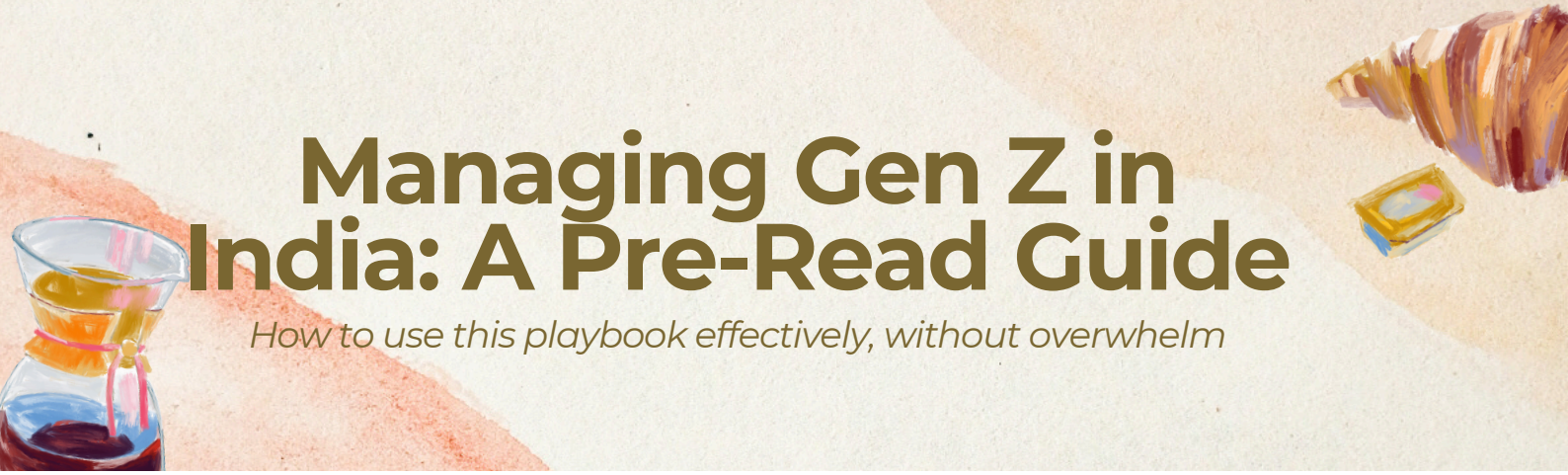
If You Are a Founder or Startup Leader

Your biggest challenges are likely:

- blurred boundaries
- emotional overload
- inconsistent standards

Start with:

- Module 5 (Burnout & Mental Health)
- Module 6 (Discipline Without Toxicity)



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How to use the Scripts in this Playbook?

This playbook contains **ready-to-use scripts.**

They exist to:

- reduce emotional escalation
- provide neutral language under pressure
- protect fairness and clarity

How to use them effectively:

- Use scripts **as written** the first few times
- Focus on **intent**, not memorisation
- Adapt tone later, once confidence builds
- Avoid improvising when emotions are high

Scripts are **training wheels,** not permanent crutches.

Consistency matters more than perfect phrasing.

Managing Gen Z in India: A Pre-Read Guide

How to use this playbook effectively, without overwhelm

Before you begin:

This playbook is not about redefining leadership or introducing a new management philosophy.

It is about **operating effectively in a workforce context that has evolved.**

As you move into the playbook:

- approach it with curiosity rather than agreement
- focus on patterns rather than isolated incidents
- apply your judgment to what feels relevant in your context

You do not need to adopt every suggestion.
You do not need to read the playbook linearly.

Use it as a **reference** during moments that matter — particularly when conversations feel complex, emotionally charged, or unclear.

Your experience remains your strongest leadership asset.
This playbook is designed to support and sharpen it.